

10 Financial Questions to Ask Your Partner Before You Move In Together

Above all else, you have to get over your fear of talking about money as soon as possible. If you're about to join forces, combine your lives, and move in together, you need to know about your partner's relationship to money. That relationship will be joining you in yours, by the way. It isn't going to be just the two of you; it's the two of you plus the money (or debt) you bring to the relationship. Here's a list of questions you will want answers to before calling in the movers.

1. How much do you make a year (you'd be surprised at how few couples know this about each other!), and how do you imagine splitting our finances in the future?
2. How much debt do you have? How much of it is credit card debt?
3. Do you want kids? How many? (Yes, this is part of a financial decision.)
4. Have you ever been bankrupt or had a business that went under? How and why? How's your credit history now?
5. Do you borrow, or have you borrowed, money from family or friends?
6. Do you gamble or buy lottery tickets?
7. Do you have a pension or anything saved for retirement?
8. What about cars? Do you lease or own?
9. Do you have student loans? Are you making regular payments?
10. Describe your money style. Do you consider yourself a big spender or super frugal? What's more important to you: fancy holidays or paying down a mortgage?

These questions are just guidelines. I'm asking you to be as curious about your partner's financial history as you are about his or her familial, sexual, and educational background. If you have completely different financial styles and expectations, now is the time to find out, before you buy that condo together or walk down the aisle. What you're looking for is balance. Your potential partner is neither too